

WESTERN CHARTER HOUSE

A Civic Institution for British Columbia

Western Thinking. Enduring Principles.



Our Philosophical Foundation

Western Charter House anchors its work in enduring conservative principles, expressed through a right-wing populist framework tailored to British Columbia's unique challenges and opportunities. We trust proven traditions, defend ordered liberty, and reject utopian experiments that ignore human nature.

Philosophical Conservatism

- **Humility before history:** No generation is wiser than the accumulated wisdom of the past. Radical change usually produces unintended harm.
- **Ordered liberty:** Freedom requires moral order, personal responsibility, and strong institutions (family, community, civil society) that shape character.
- **Skepticism of utopias:** Human nature is flawed and unchanging. Schemes promising perfect equality or endless progress end in coercion.

Economic Conservatism

- **Private property & free enterprise:** The right to own, use, and trade property is the foundation of liberty and innovation. Government protects it — does not seize or micromanage it.
- **Fiscal responsibility:** Balanced budgets, low taxes, and minimal debt protect future generations from politicians buying votes with other people's money.
- **Opportunity over enforced outcomes:** We judge systems by whether they expand opportunity and reward work and risk — not by identical results for everyone.

Cultural Conservatism & Right-Wing Populism

A healthy society needs shared identity, moral order, and trust. We defend Canada's (and the West's) Judeo-Christian roots, English common law, and Enlightenment achievements. Right-wing populism adds urgency: **sovereignty first** — provincial control over borders, resources, and decisions against supranational overreach (UN/WEF-style mandates). It demands direct economic opportunity for working British Columbians through resource development, tax relief, merit-based policy, and zero-tolerance for crime and disorder. Conservatism preserves; right-wing populism reclaims and rebuilds.

Where conservatism trusts institutions and gradual change, our approach is a fighting creed for this era: reclaim democratic control for British Columbians, deliver results for working families, and restore social cohesion through accountability and common culture.

The Four Strategic Pillars

All activity at Western Charter House is organized around four integrated pillars. These replace fragmented ‘think tank + activist + convening’ arms with a focused, high-impact operating model optimized for BC’s media environment and member engagement.

1. Short-Form Thought Leadership & Briefs

Rapid-response, shareable content that cuts through noise: 4–8 page policy briefs or 60–90 second video explainers. Format: Problem → Government Action → Real-World Outcome → Principled Alternative (with 1–2 clear charts). Release cadence: 4+ per month. Optimized for X, Instagram, Facebook, TikTok, and member sharing. Every brief ends with a clear “What You Can Do” call-to-action (pre-written MLA email template, petition link). Examples: “Why BC Housing Remains Broken”, “Healthcare Wait Times 2026: \$2.8B More Spending, Same Crisis”, “Crime Reset: Repeat Offender Reality vs. Safer Communities Plan”.

2. Long-Form Policy Research

Quarterly in-depth papers (12–20 pages) and the flagship **Annual BC Policy Scorecard** (released every February after the provincial budget, with mid-year update). The Scorecard covers eight priority areas: Housing, Healthcare/Wait Times, Public Safety & Crime, Taxes & Spending, Resource Development & Energy, Education & School Choice, Governance & Transparency, and Cost of Living. Each entry: What Government Tried → Measurable Outcome/Data → Grade → MLAs Defending vs. Pushing Reform → Right-Wing Fix. Built from BC Stats, Auditor General reports, FOI requests, Hansard, and primary data. Regional chapters supply riding-specific examples. Tone: fact-based, non-ranting accountability. Gives members crystal-clear talking points and evidence.

3. Communications & Media

Professional public voice and narrative control. Handles media relations, press releases, digital campaigns, messaging frameworks, and rapid response. Positions Western Charter House as the credible, competent, modern conservative/populist voice in British Columbia — not a protest group, but a political force. Includes branding, website content, social strategy, and coordination with short-form output. Goal: every major policy debate in BC has our research and perspective in the mix, framed clearly for working families and sovereignty.

4. Public Engagement & Grassroots Mobilization

The membership engine that turns research into power. **Target audience:** Disenfranchised center-right to right-wing British Columbians who feel ignored by NDP, Liberals, and sometimes even BC Conservatives.

Membership Structure

- **Basic (Free):** Newsletter signup, basic updates.
 - **Full (\$40/year):** Personalized membership card + optional pin/sticker, quarterly print or premium digital newsletter, Telegram channel access, policy briefings, candidate scorecards, members-only webinars, local event invites, easy tools to contact MLAs or file FOI requests, volunteer opportunities for campaigns.
- Payment: Simple Stripe one-click, annual auto-renew, easy cancel. Slightly above some competitors to fund higher-quality research.

Grassroots Structure

Four volunteer-led regional chapters (Okanagan, Lower Mainland, Interior, Island) overseeing 93 riding-level sections. Each riding has a Riding Captain (full member, 2–5 hrs/week volunteer) equipped with MLA contact lists, pre-written templates, petition scripts, and latest scorecard data. Website allows instant join/volunteer by riding dropdown. Chapters run quarterly policy forums/town halls (low-cost community venues or hybrid). Monthly “Action of the Month” tied directly to think-tank output. “Blitz weeks” for coordinated pressure on specific issues.

Talent Pipeline & Accountability

Identify and train sharp operators (young professionals, small-business owners, community leaders). Quarterly half-day training (communications, campaign strategy, data advocacy, media). Placement program: embed trained members into MLA constituency offices, party riding associations, and aligned candidate campaigns. Annual public candidate/party vetting questionnaires (10–15 clear yes/no + short-answer questions) with published results and “Declined to Answer” notations. This forces accountability — MLAs know their stances will be public.

Unified Voting Bloc: Release questionnaires and scorecards before elections/nominations. Encourage informed, issue-based bloc voting for strongest right-wing solutions (fully compliant). During elections: pure issue advocacy (unlimited) or register as third-party sponsor if running ads.

Revenue Model, Team & Implementation

Revenue & Funding Strategy

Adopts the proven private-donation model of the Fraser Institute: zero core government funding or contract research. This preserves full independence and credibility when critiquing the very institutions that might otherwise fund us.

Target mix: 60% membership dues (builds loyal base), 40% transparent donations from individuals and small businesses (tax receipts available via non-profit arm; otherwise standard receipts). No massive corporate “partner” fees that could compromise grassroots independence. Additional revenue from the for-profit corporation: premium events (e.g., annual BC Affairs Summit at accessible ~\$100 tickets + sponsorships), publications, and digital products.

Startup phase target: \$500,000–\$1M seed from high-net-worth British Columbians/Albertans, resource-sector leaders, and aligned family foundations. Annual donor report published for transparency (consistent with Fraser best practices). This model is scalable, authentic, and aligned with our principles of sovereignty and opportunity.

Core Leadership Team

- **Paul Custance** — CEO & Co-Founder: Vision, strategy, major decisions, external representation.
 - **Anthony Russo** — COO & Co-Founder: Day-to-day operations, execution, internal processes.
 - **Jake Bregolis** — Director of Government Affairs / Chief Lobbyist
 - **Brittany Foute** — Communications Director
 - **Sebastine Zane** — Policy Director / Senior Policy Analyst
 - **Opie Singh** — Policy Analyst
 - Additional roles in development: Legal & Compliance Counsel, Finance Director/Treasurer, Fundraising/Development Director, Website/IT Lead.
- Board of Directors (independent oversight) + growing volunteer network and Chapter Executives across BC.

Key BC Problems We Tackle

Housing supply blocked by zoning/green tape • Healthcare shortages and wait times • Post-decriminalization crime and fentanyl crisis • Sky-high cost of living and deficits • Over-regulation killing resource jobs and energy projects • Education outcomes and lack of school choice • Governance transparency and DRIPA/UNDRIP impacts • Judicial activism and public safety • Equality of opportunity, not outcomes • Better relationships with neighboring provinces and states.

Cascadia Strategy (How We Win)

1. **Build the Talent Pipeline** — Recruit, train, and place sharp operators inside campaigns, MLA offices, and party structures.
2. **Own 2–3 Key Issues** — Dominate a few high-impact issues with relentless clarity (housing, crime, sovereignty).
3. **Move as a Voting Bloc** — Coordinated, disciplined action in leadership races, nominations, and elections. A focused 500 beats a scattered 5,000.
4. **Apply Strategic Pressure** — Coordinated outreach, timed public moments, reward alignment, withdraw support when ignored.
5. **Control the Perception** — Professional, modern, disciplined, competent — never chaotic or reactive. We are a political force, not a protest group.

Year 1 Rollout & Starting Steps

Launch is achievable in 2–3 months at very low cost (<\$2,000 initial outlay beyond sweat equity).

- **Pre-Launch:** Social channels (X, YouTube, TikTok, Facebook, Instagram), landing page, basic brand assets.
- **Q1:** Incorporate non-profit society (~\$130 online), parallel corporation if needed, recruit first Riding Captains via newsletter, run 2–3 pilot town halls in Okanagan base.
- **Q2–Q4:** Roll out training program, tie every policy paper/brief to a concrete activist campaign (petitions, letters, events).

